

Research Status Note

Public CAD Is Not Operational Ground Truth

25 August 2026

Current result

The New Orleans public CAD measurement product changes before Hurricane Ida and changes again during Ida. The supported object is a public-field configuration, not physical dispatch, arrival, capacity, response quality, domestic-violence incidence, or a mechanism.

What is now established.

- A first-hand audit of the official July 2021 CSV confirms the first non-officer J_{01} records on 28 July and a simultaneous officer-stream dispatch-field collapse; nonblank timestamps remain parseable.
- Ida's standardized maximum-cell contrast is 0.5072, rank 1/154. The support-independent full-count contrast is 0.5320, rank 1/152; a 4,000-draw rank bootstrap places Ida first in every draw.
- The standardized comparison covers 86.1 percent of event and 77.0 percent of baseline records and fails the 0.90 reference eligibility rule, so it is not presented as the full-population result.
- The comparable non-officer dispatch-field series is 65.4 percent (2024), 66.0 percent (2025), and 66.8 percent (2026 snapshot). The 2025 all-row rate is 41.8 percent because officer-initiated records have a different public-field convention.
- Public institutional documents define field labels and exclude the 2022 Carbyne cutover and unlaunched Hexagon records project as explanations for the July 2021 break. They do not identify the remaining mechanism.

Deliverables. A standalone main paper, a methods-focused empirical supplement, this one-page note, a reproduction manual, and a separate legacy mathematical/formal-verification archive. The professor-facing combined PDF contains only the main paper and empirical supplement.

Remaining evidence need. A versioned 2021 changelog or privacy-safe internal/public reconciliation that binds operational events, entry history, retention, and export fields. Without that bridge, causal and performance interpretations remain outside the evidence.